You can prepare the meatballs ahead for this recipe. Allow approximately 30 minutes to reheat the broth, add the meatballs, and finish off the cooking.

cabbage and tomato soup with meatballs

SERVES 4 **PREP** 40 MINS **COOK** 1 HOUR **FREEZE** UP TO 3 MONTHS
SOUP AND MEATBALLS SEPARATELY

for the meatballs
1 garlic clove, crushed
½ Spanish onion, finely chopped
½ tsp hot smoked paprika
½ tsp ground cumin
1 tsp dried thyme (or fresh leaves)
2 tbsp freshly grated Parmesan cheese
breadcrumbs made from 2 slices bread
14oz (400g) ground steak
1 large egg
sea salt and freshly ground black pepper
3 tbsp flour
3 tbsp vegetable oil
1 tbsp butter

for the soup
2 tbsp vegetable oil
½ Spanish onion, coarsely chopped
1 garlic clove, crushed
9oz (250g) tomatoes, seeded and chopped
1 large Savoy cabbage, halved, core and ribs discarded, and leaves sliced into bite-sized pieces
sea salt and freshly ground black pepper
1 quart (1 liter) beef stock
2 tbsp finely chopped parsley, to finish
3 tbsp grated or shaved Parmesan cheese

1 For the meatballs, put the first nine ingredients in a bowl, season, and mix well. Shape into walnut-sized balls and refrigerate for 30 minutes.

2 Heat the oil in a large deep pan over medium heat. Add in the onion, garlic, and tomatoes. Cook for 3–5 minutes, stirring. Add the cabbage and stir for 3 minutes. Stir in the stock and simmer for 15–20 minutes.

3 Meanwhile, sift the flour onto a plate and coat the meatballs. Heat the oil and butter in a pan over medium-high heat. Add the meatballs and cook for 3 minutes until they are a rich brown all over. Add to the soup and simmer for 15–20 minutes. Serve scattered with parsley and Parmesan.